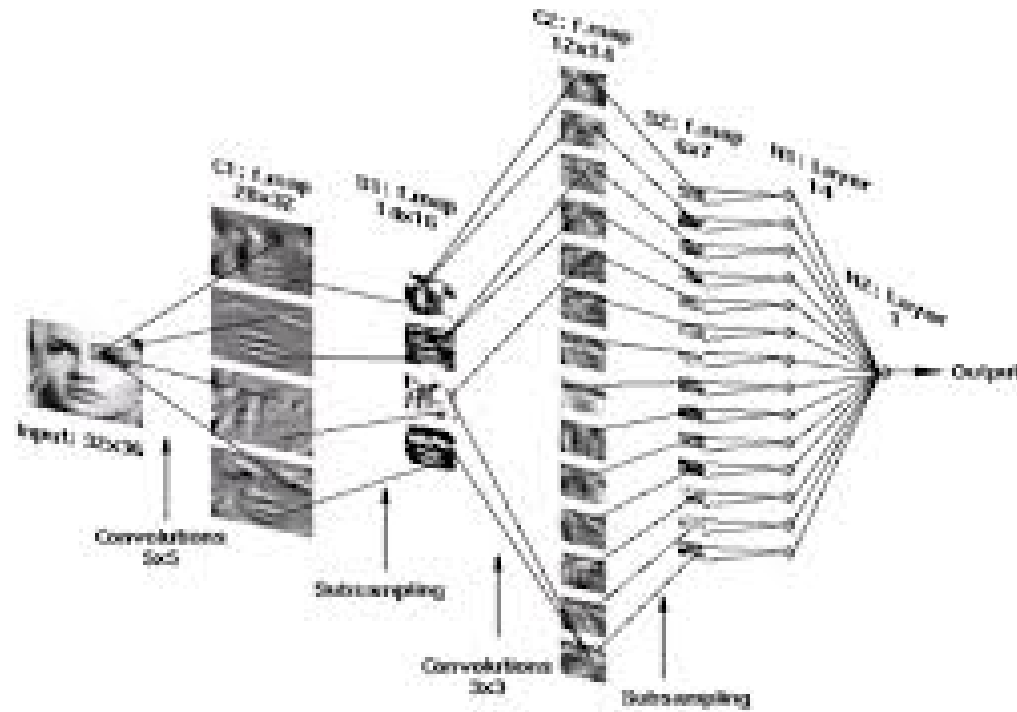


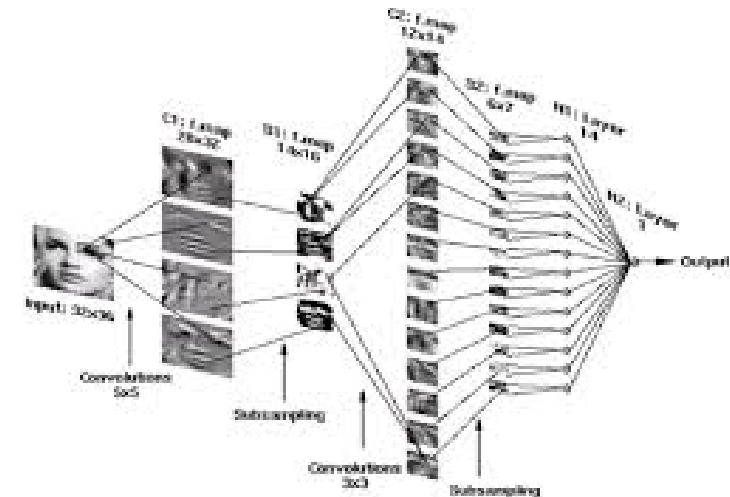
Introduction



Course Details and Topics

Outline

1. **Why are you doing this course?**
2. What we assume that you know



Orientation

- This course addresses three cohorts of students:
 - ★ Third year Artificial Intelligence Students
 - ★ MSc in Machine Learning Students
 - ★ Volunteers
- It is dual coded (AICE3001/AICE6002), with subtle difference in expectations reflected in slightly different evaluation
- Notes are on Moodle and
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- LLMs can help us a lot, but if you don't trust yourself you are disempowered
- This course is aimed at building up trust in your understanding of how machine learning works

Why Mathematics?

- Learning machines are notoriously difficult to understand
- Mathematics allows us to reason rigorously
- Posing question mathematically and seeking mathematical solutions provide allow us to build a strong intuition
- Mathematics also allow us to describe the world precisely
- It also provides an arsenal of tools that turn out to be hugely useful

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Cracking the Code

- Mathematics is a language that takes time to master
- For some it is easy, for others it will be a struggle
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Starting from Different Places

- You all start from different places
- Some of you may have a degree in mathematics
- For others it may have been your least favourite subject
- I invite strong mathematicians to become even stronger
- For students starting from a weak base, judge yourselves by your progress, not by comparing yourself to others

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The Journey

- We are going to visit lots of aspects of mathematics that have proved fruitful in machine learning
- Some of this will be very concrete, while in other cases by look at a higher level of abstraction we can generalise methods across different application areas
- We will cover, calculus, vector spaces, convexity, optimisation, entropy, probability, statistics and much else besides
- The journey will pay you off, these are the foundations of most of machine learning and will give you super-powers that are hard to acquire without mathematics

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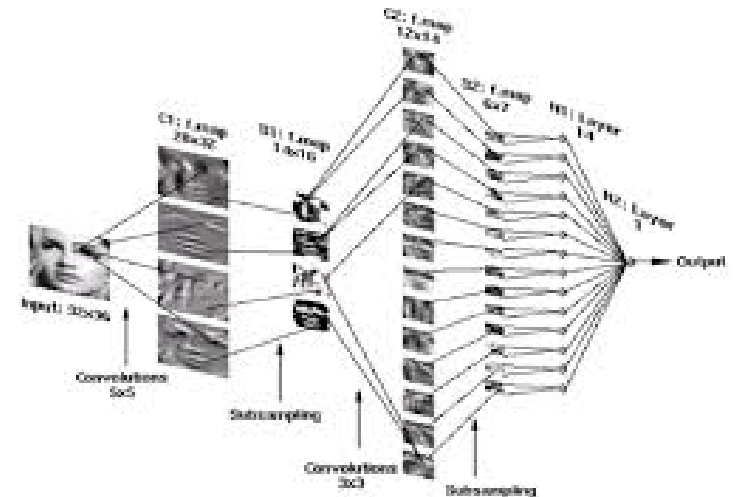
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What we Assume you Know

- You should all have A-level mathematics and have done some mathematics at Uni
- You should know what a function is, e.g. $f(x) = x^2 + 3$
- You should be able to do simple algebraic manipulations
- And some elementary calculus

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Vectors

- Ordinary vectors (what mathematicians call elements of $\mathbb{R}^n$) are much used in machine learning and should be familiar
- We will use bold symbols to represent **column vectors**, e.g.

$$\boldsymbol{x} = \begin{pmatrix} 1.2 \\ 2.3 \\ 4.7 \end{pmatrix}$$

- We denote **row vectors** as the **transpose** of column vectors
 $\boldsymbol{x}^T = (1.2, 2.3, 4.7)$
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Matrices

- Matrices are blocks of number that define linear mappings between vectors, e.g. $\mathbf{M} \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3}$

$$\mathbf{M} = \begin{pmatrix} 1.1 & -2.1 & 6.2 \\ 9.3 & 3.1 & -4.4 \end{pmatrix}$$

- An $m \times n$ matrix (i.e. $\mathbf{M} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$) has m rows and n columns
- An $m \times n$ matrix acting on a vector in $\mathbb{R}^n$ transforms it to $\mathbb{R}^m$ vector, e.g.

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Composition of Mappings

- Matrices, $\mathbf{A}$, $\mathbf{B}$, etc. represent mappings between spaces
- Provided the matrices are the correct size we can compose these mappings, e.g. if $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{\ell \times m}$ and $\mathbf{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ then $\mathbf{AB}$ represents the effect of
 - ★ first applying $\mathbf{B}$ to vectors in $\mathbb{R}^n$ to obtain vectors in $\mathbb{R}^m$
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Matrix Multiplication

- The combined mapping $\mathbf{AB}$ can be represented by an $\ell \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{C}$ which we can compute using matrix multiplication (rows times columns)

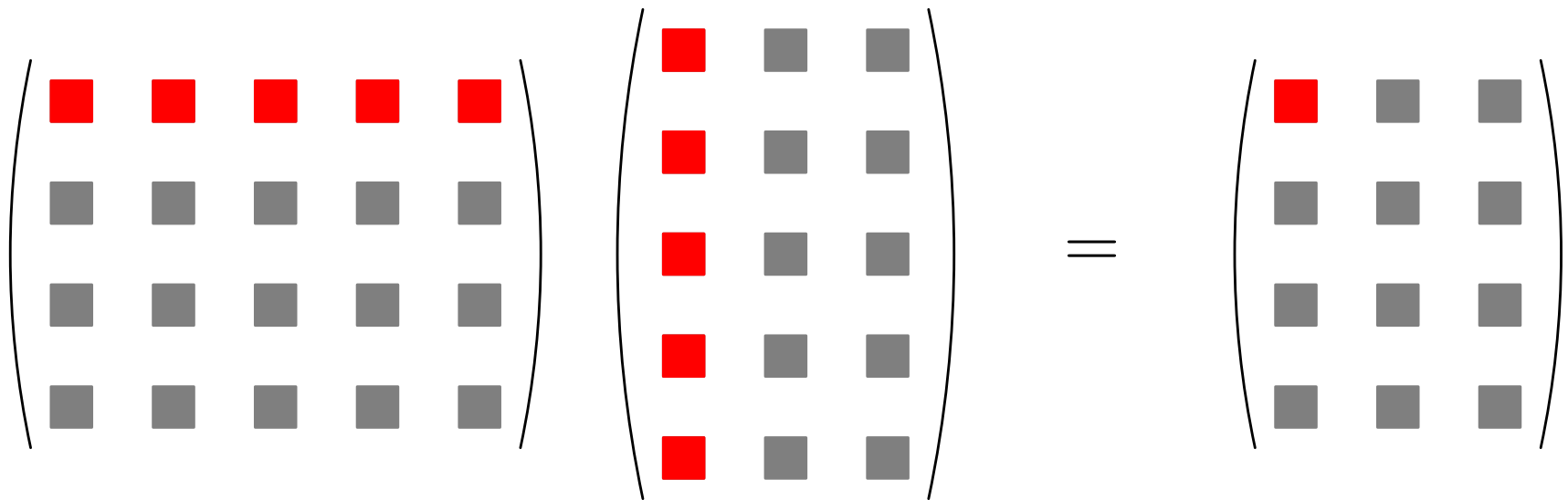
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The diagram illustrates matrix multiplication using a visual representation of matrices as grids of squares. The first matrix, representing $\mathbf{A}$, is a 5x5 grid with 5 rows and 5 columns. The second matrix, representing $\mathbf{B}$, is a 5x3 grid with 5 rows and 3 columns. An equals sign follows, leading to the resulting matrix $\mathbf{C}$, which is a 5x3 grid with 5 rows and 3 columns. This visualizes the operation $\mathbf{AB} = \mathbf{C}$.

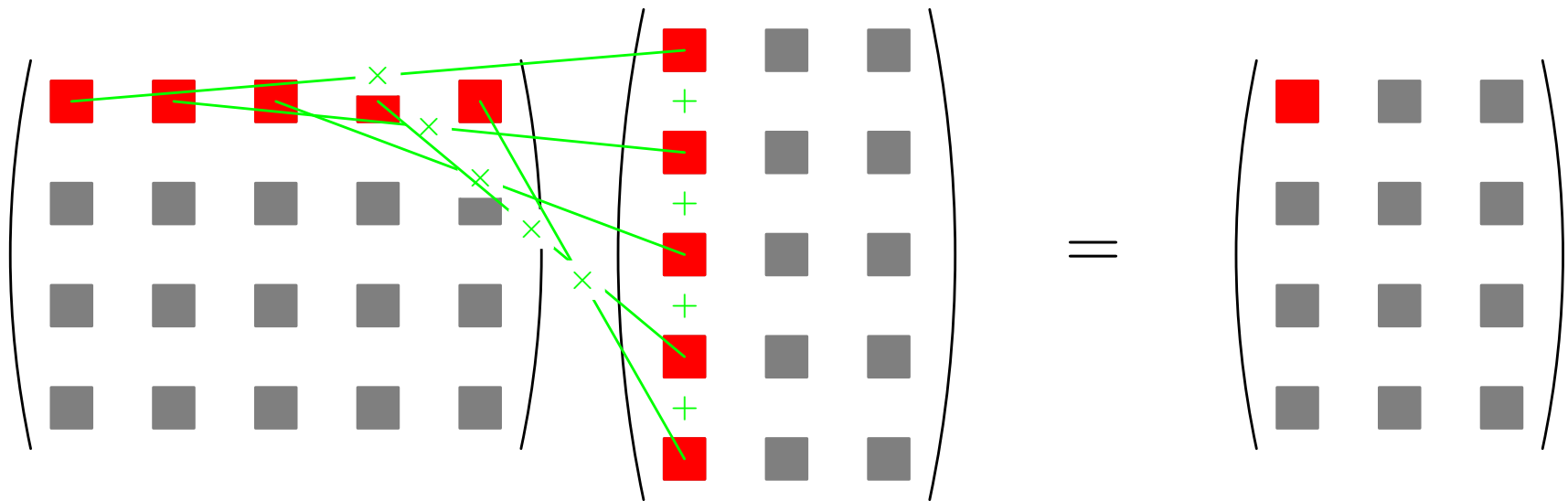
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$$\begin{pmatrix} \text{red} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix}$$

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The diagram illustrates matrix multiplication using a grid of squares. The first matrix is 4 rows by 5 columns. The top row consists of 5 red squares, while the other three rows consist of 5 gray squares each. The second matrix is 5 rows by 3 columns. The first four rows consist of 3 gray squares each, and the fifth row consists of 3 red squares. An equals sign follows, leading to the resulting matrix, which is 4 rows by 3 columns. The first three rows consist of 3 gray squares each, and the fourth row consists of 3 red squares. This represents the calculation of the product matrix $\mathbf{C}$ where each element is the dot product of a row from the first matrix and a column from the second matrix.

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The diagram illustrates the matrix multiplication $\mathbf{AB} = \mathbf{C}$ using a visual representation of matrices as grids of squares. The first matrix (4x5) has a red square in the second row, first column. The second matrix (5x3) has red squares in the first, second, third, fourth, and fifth rows, first column. The result matrix (4x3) has a red square in the second row, first column.

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Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray	=	Gray	Gray	Gray
Red	Red	Red	Red	Red		Gray	Red	Gray
Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray		Gray	Gray	Gray
Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray		Gray	Gray	Gray
Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray	Gray		Gray	Gray	Gray

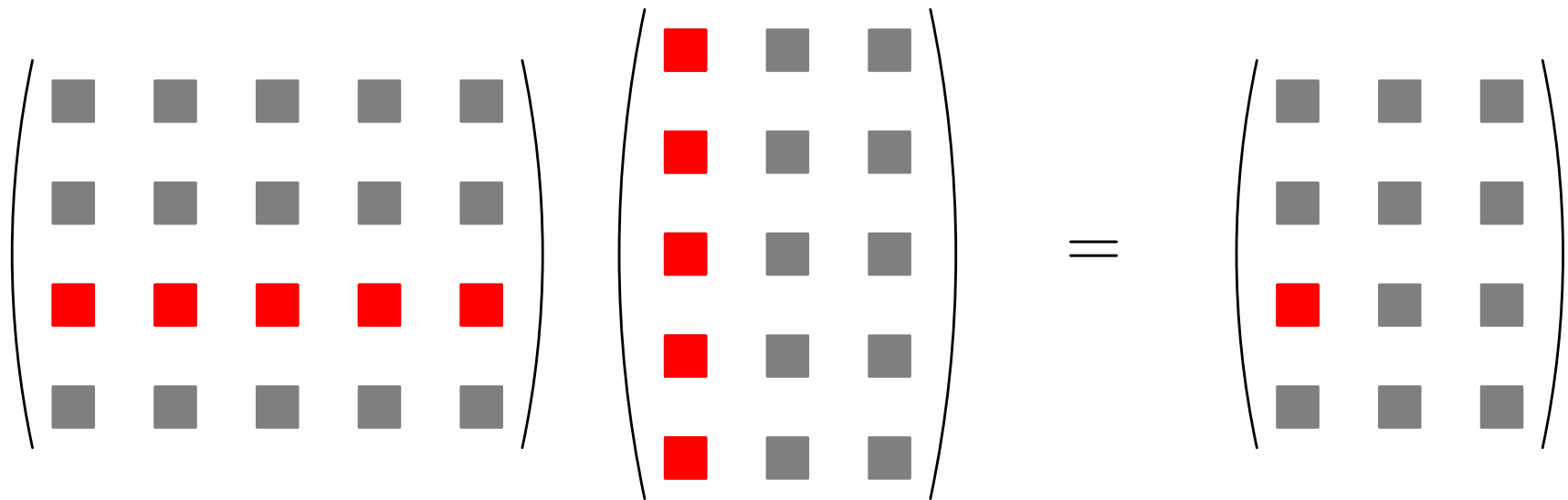
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The diagram illustrates matrix multiplication using a grid of squares. The first matrix (A) is 5 rows by 5 columns. The second matrix (B) is 5 rows by 3 columns. The result matrix (C) is 5 rows by 3 columns. The red squares indicate the non-zero elements in the matrices.

Matrix A (5x5)	Matrix B (5x3)	Result Matrix C (5x3)
Gray	Gray	Gray
Gray	Gray	Gray
Red	Red	Red
Gray	Gray	Gray
Gray	Gray	Gray

Matrix Multiplication

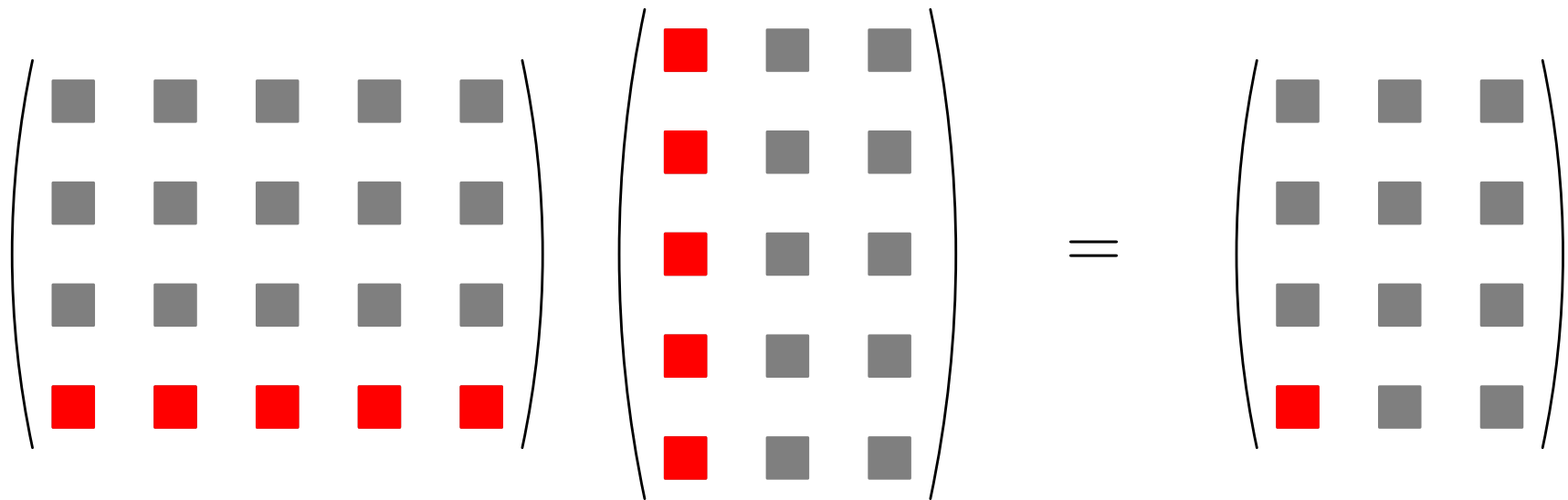
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$$\begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{red} & \text{red} & \text{red} & \text{red} & \text{red} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{red} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix}$$

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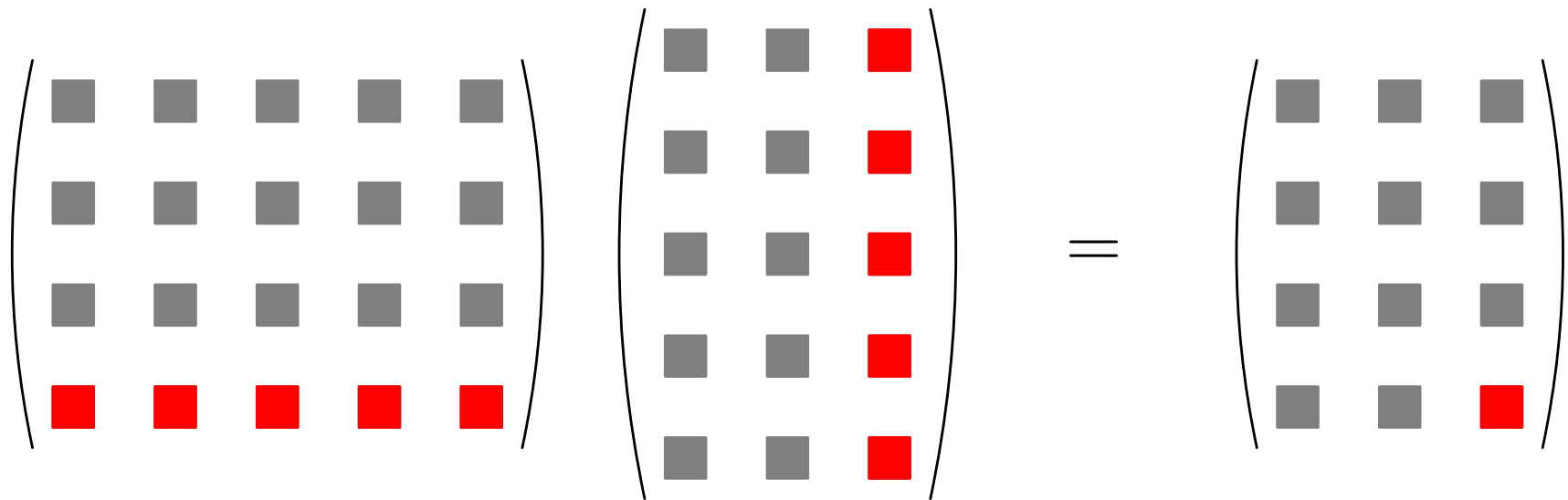
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The diagram illustrates matrix multiplication using a grid of squares. The first matrix is a 4x5 grid with 4 rows and 5 columns. The bottom row is highlighted in red, while the other three rows are gray. The second matrix is a 5x3 grid with 5 rows and 3 columns. The middle column is highlighted in red, while the other two columns are gray. An equals sign follows, leading to the resulting 4x3 matrix. This matrix has 4 rows and 3 columns. The bottom-middle square (row 4, column 2) is highlighted in red, while the other squares are gray.

Matrix Multiplication

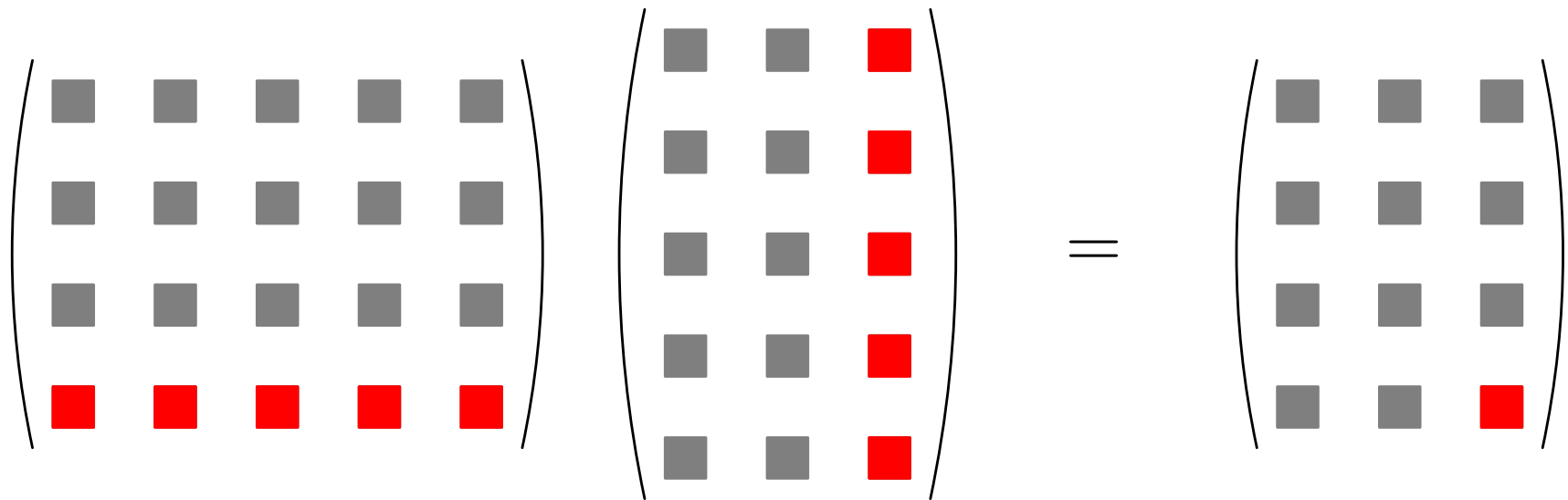
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The diagram illustrates matrix multiplication using a grid of squares. The first matrix is a 4x5 grid with 4 rows and 5 columns. The first three rows consist of 5 gray squares each. The fourth row consists of 5 red squares. The second matrix is a 5x3 grid with 5 rows and 3 columns. The first four rows consist of 2 gray squares followed by 1 red square. The fifth row consists of 2 gray squares followed by 1 red square. An equals sign follows, and the resulting matrix is a 4x3 grid with 4 rows and 3 columns. The first three rows consist of 3 gray squares each. The fourth row consists of 2 gray squares followed by 1 red square.

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- Matrix multiplication is associative: $(\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{A}(\mathbf{BC})$

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- Matrix multiplication is associative: $(\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{A}(\mathbf{BC})$
- But in general not commutative $\mathbf{AB} \neq \mathbf{BA}$

Transpose

- We often encounter transposes of a matrix $\mathbf{M}^T$ where we have exchanged the rows and columns: $[\mathbf{M}^T]_{ij} = [\mathbf{M}]_{ji}$
- Clear $(\mathbf{M}^T)^T = \mathbf{M}$
- It is simple question of book keeping to show that

$$(\mathbf{AB})^T = \mathbf{B}^T \mathbf{A}^T$$

- For a symmetric matrix $\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{M}^T$
- Since 1×1 matrices are always symmetric

$$\mathbf{a}^T \mathbf{b} = (\mathbf{a}^T \mathbf{b})^T = \mathbf{b}^T \mathbf{a}$$

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- Clear $(\mathbf{M}^T)^T = \mathbf{M}$
- It is simple question of book keeping to show that

$$(\mathbf{AB})^T = \mathbf{B}^T \mathbf{A}^T$$

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- We often encounter transposes of a matrix $\mathbf{M}^\top$ where we have exchanged the rows and columns: $[\mathbf{M}^\top]_{ij} = [\mathbf{M}]_{ji}$
- Clear $(\mathbf{M}^\top)^\top = \mathbf{M}$
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$$(\mathbf{AB})^\top = \mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top$$

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$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{b} &= (\mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{b})^\top = \mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{a} \\ \mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{M} \mathbf{b} &= \mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{M}^\top \mathbf{a} \end{aligned}$$

Matrix-Vector Multiplication

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The diagram illustrates the concept of treating a column vector as a matrix for multiplication. It shows a 4x5 matrix (represented by a grid of 20 gray squares) multiplied by a 5x1 column vector (represented by a single column of 5 gray squares). This is equated to a single 4x1 column vector (represented by a single column of 4 gray squares). The entire expression is enclosed in large parentheses, with an equals sign in the middle.

Matrix-Vector Multiplication

- We can treat a column vector as a $n \times 1$ matrix
- Then matrix-vector multiplication can be treated the same as matrix multiplication

The diagram illustrates matrix-vector multiplication as matrix multiplication. It shows a 4x5 matrix (represented by a grid of 20 squares, with the top row highlighted in red) multiplied by a 5x1 column vector (represented by a single column of 5 red squares). This is followed by an equals sign and a 4x1 column vector (represented by a single column of 4 squares, with the top square highlighted in red). The entire expression is enclosed in large parentheses.

$$\begin{pmatrix} \text{4x5 matrix} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \text{5x1 column vector} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \text{4x1 column vector} \end{pmatrix}$$

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The diagram illustrates matrix-vector multiplication as matrix multiplication. On the left, a 5x5 matrix is shown with its second row highlighted in red. This matrix is multiplied by a 5x1 column vector, also with its second element highlighted in red. The result is a 5x1 column vector where only the second element is highlighted in red, representing the dot product of the second row of the matrix and the column vector.

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The diagram illustrates matrix-vector multiplication as matrix multiplication. It shows a 5x5 matrix (represented by a grid of squares, with the third row highlighted in red) multiplied by a 5x1 column vector (represented by a single column of squares, with the third element highlighted in red). The result is a 5x1 column vector (represented by a single column of squares, with the third element highlighted in red). The equation is shown as:

$$\begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{red} & \text{red} & \text{red} & \text{red} & \text{red} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \text{red} \\ \text{red} \\ \text{red} \\ \text{red} \\ \text{red} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} \\ \text{red} \\ \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} \end{pmatrix}$$

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- Then matrix-vector multiplication can be treated the same as matrix multiplication

The diagram illustrates matrix-vector multiplication as matrix multiplication. On the left, a 4x5 matrix is shown with 4 rows and 5 columns. The first three rows contain gray squares, and the fourth row contains red squares. This matrix is multiplied by a 5x1 column vector on the right, which consists of five red squares. An equals sign follows, leading to a 4x1 column vector on the right, which consists of four gray squares. This visualizes the operation where each row of the matrix is multiplied by the column vector, and the results are stacked to form a new column vector.

Inner Products

- The dot or inner-product between two vectors with the same number of elements, can be written $\mathbf{a}^T \mathbf{b}$

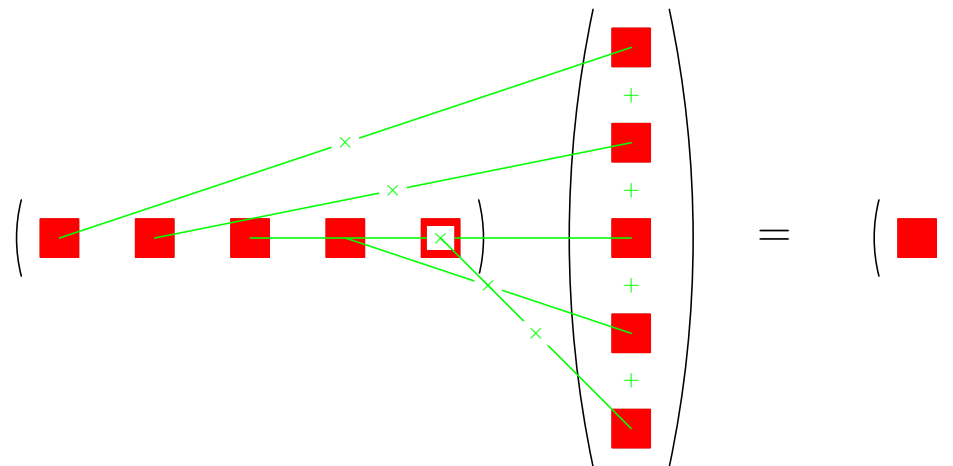
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$$\left(\begin{array}{ccccc} \blacksquare & \blacksquare & \blacksquare & \blacksquare & \blacksquare \end{array} \right) = \left(\begin{array}{c} \blacksquare \\ \blacksquare \\ \blacksquare \\ \blacksquare \\ \blacksquare \end{array} \right) = \left(\blacksquare \right)$$

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- Inner products encode angles between vectors

$$\mathbf{a}^T \mathbf{b} = \|\mathbf{a}\| \|\mathbf{b}\| \cos(\theta)$$

Outer Products

- We can also define the outer-product between any size vectors,
 ab^T

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- We can also define the outer-product between any size vectors, ab^T

The diagram illustrates the outer product operation ab^T . On the left, a column vector a of size 4x1 is represented by a large left parenthesis followed by four gray squares stacked vertically, and a large right parenthesis. This is multiplied by a row vector b^T of size 1x3, represented by a large left parenthesis followed by three gray squares, and a large right parenthesis. An equals sign follows, leading to the resulting 4x3 matrix. This matrix is shown as a large left parenthesis followed by four rows, each containing three gray squares, and a large right parenthesis.

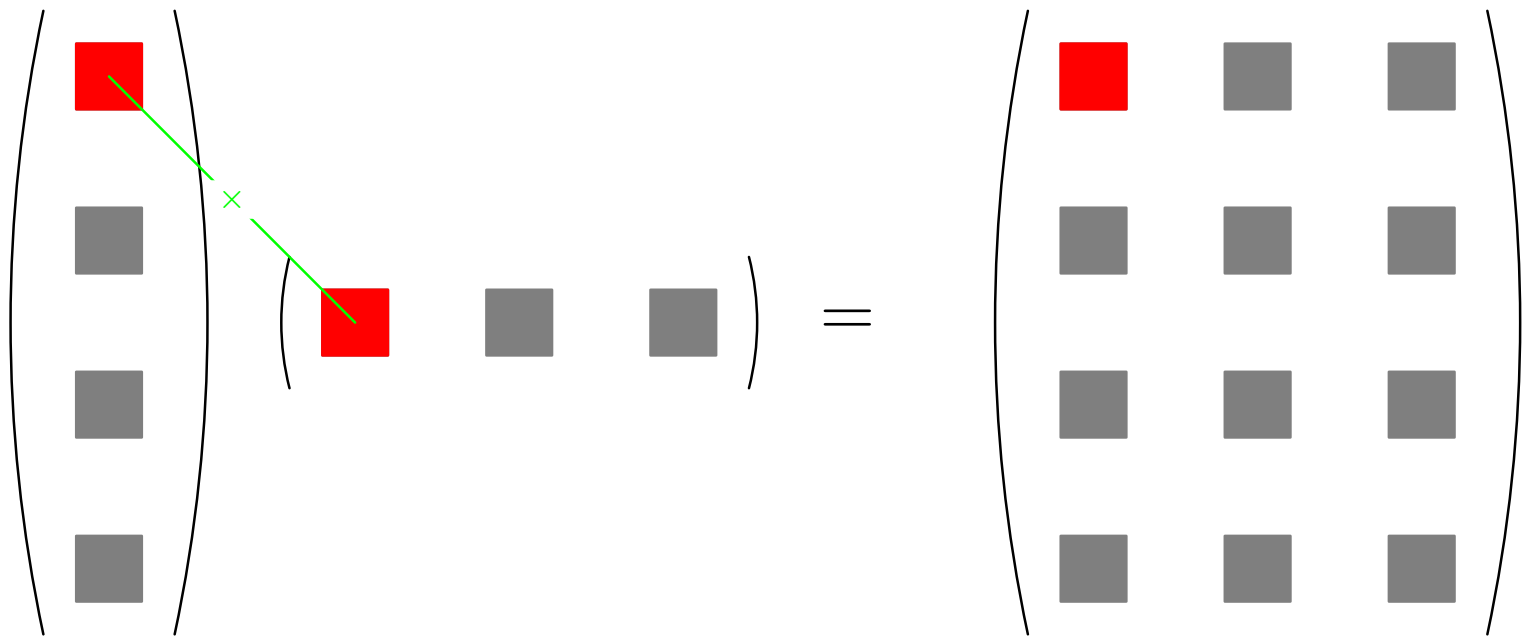
Outer Products

- We can also define the outer-product between any size vectors, ab^T

The diagram illustrates the outer product of two vectors. On the left, a column vector of size 4x1 is shown, with its top element highlighted in red and the others in gray. This is multiplied by a row vector of size 1x3, also with its first element highlighted in red and the others in gray. An equals sign follows, leading to a 4x3 matrix on the right. Each row of this matrix corresponds to one of the four elements of the first vector. The first row contains one red square followed by two gray squares, representing the first row of the resulting matrix where every element is the product of the first element of the first vector and the corresponding element of the second vector. The subsequent three rows each contain three gray squares, representing the other three rows of the matrix.

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The diagram illustrates the outer product of two vectors. On the left, a column vector of size 4x1 is shown, with its top element highlighted in red. This is multiplied by a row vector of size 1x3, with its middle element highlighted in red. The result is a 4x3 matrix where the second column is entirely red, representing the outer product of the original vectors.

$$\begin{pmatrix} \color{red}\blacksquare \\ \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \color{red}\blacksquare & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \text{gray} & \color{red}\blacksquare & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \\ \text{gray} & \text{gray} & \text{gray} \end{pmatrix}$$

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The diagram illustrates the outer product of two vectors. On the left, a column vector is shown with four elements: the top element is a red square, and the three elements below it are gray squares. This vector is enclosed in large parentheses. To its right is a row vector with three elements: two gray squares followed by a red square, also enclosed in large parentheses. An equals sign follows. To the right of the equals sign is a 4x3 matrix enclosed in large parentheses. The matrix consists of four rows and three columns. The first column contains four gray squares, the second column contains four gray squares, and the third column contains a red square at the top, followed by three gray squares. This represents the result of the outer product of the first vector and the second vector.

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The diagram illustrates the outer product operation ab^T . On the left, a column vector a of size 4x1 is shown, with its second element highlighted in red. This is multiplied by a row vector b^T of size 1x3, with its first element highlighted in red. The result is a 4x3 matrix where each row is a scalar multiple of the vector b^T , and the first row is identical to b^T because the second element of a is 1 (implied by the red highlight). The matrix has 4 rows and 3 columns, with the first row containing one red square and two gray squares, and the remaining three rows containing three gray squares each.

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The diagram illustrates the outer product of two vectors. On the left, a column vector of size 4 is shown, with its second element highlighted in red. This is multiplied by a row vector of size 3, with its second element also highlighted in red. The result is a 4x3 matrix where every element in the second row and second column is red, while all other elements are gray.

$$\begin{pmatrix} \square \\ \color{red}\square \\ \square \\ \square \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \square & \color{red}\square & \square \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \color{red}\square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \end{pmatrix}$$

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The diagram illustrates the outer product operation ab^T using square blocks to represent matrix elements. On the left, a column vector a of size 4x1 is shown, with its third element highlighted in red. This is multiplied by a row vector b^T of size 1x3, with its first element highlighted in red. The result is a 4x3 matrix where each row is a scalar multiple of the vector b^T , and the third row is highlighted in red because it is the product of the red element in a and the entire row vector b^T .

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The diagram illustrates the outer product of two 4x1 vectors. On the left, a column vector of four gray squares is multiplied by a row vector of three gray squares. The result is a 4x4 matrix where the third row and third column are highlighted in red, representing the outer product of the third elements of the input vectors.

$$\begin{pmatrix} \square \\ \square \\ \square \\ \square \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \square & \square & \square \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \end{pmatrix}$$

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The diagram illustrates the outer product of two vectors. On the left, a column vector of size 4 is shown, with its third element highlighted in red. This is multiplied by a row vector of size 3, also with its third element highlighted in red. The result is a 4x3 matrix where the third row and third column are highlighted in red, representing the outer product of the original vectors.

$$\begin{pmatrix} \square \\ \square \\ \color{red}\square \\ \square \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \square & \square & \color{red}\square \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \\ \color{red}\square & \color{red}\square & \color{red}\square \\ \square & \square & \square \end{pmatrix}$$

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The diagram illustrates the outer product operation ab^T using square blocks to represent matrix elements. On the left, a column vector a of size 4x1 is shown, with its bottom element highlighted in red. This is multiplied by a row vector b^T of size 1x3, with its first element highlighted in red. The result is a 4x3 matrix on the right, where each row is a scaled version of the row vector b^T . The first row of the resulting matrix has its first element highlighted in red, corresponding to the product of the red elements in the input vectors.

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$$\begin{pmatrix} \square \\ \square \\ \square \\ \color{red}\square \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \square & \color{red}\square & \square \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \square & \square \\ \square & \color{red}\square & \square \end{pmatrix}$$

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The diagram illustrates the outer product of two vectors. On the left, a column vector of size 4 is shown, consisting of four gray squares and one red square at the bottom. This is multiplied by a row vector of size 3, consisting of two gray squares and one red square on the right. The result is a 4x3 matrix on the right, where each element is the product of the corresponding elements from the two input vectors. The bottom-right element is red, while all other elements are gray.

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The diagram illustrates the outer product of a column vector and a row vector. On the left, a column vector is shown with four elements: three gray squares and one red square at the bottom. This is multiplied by a row vector with three elements: two gray squares and one red square on the right. The result is a 4x3 matrix on the right, where each element is the product of the corresponding elements from the input vectors. The bottom-right element is red, while all other elements are gray.

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- Notice that we need to know whether we are dealing with row or column vectors

Norms

- Norms are non-negative numbers associated with the “size” of a vector
- The norm you should be familiar with is the **Euclidean Norm** or 2-norm

$$\|\mathbf{x}\|_2 = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^n x_i^2}$$

- We will see there exist other norms (using different ways of measuring size)
- The Euclidean norm is intimately related to the inner-product, we will see other examples of this for different vector spaces

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Matrices as Linear Mappings

- Matrices represent mappings between vectors

$$\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{M}\mathbf{a}$$

- The elements of $\mathbf{b}$ are **linear sums** of the elements of $\mathbf{a}$

$$b_i = \sum_j M_{ij} a_j$$

- Two important consequences of this linearity are for any real c

$$\mathbf{M}(c\mathbf{a}) = c(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{a})$$

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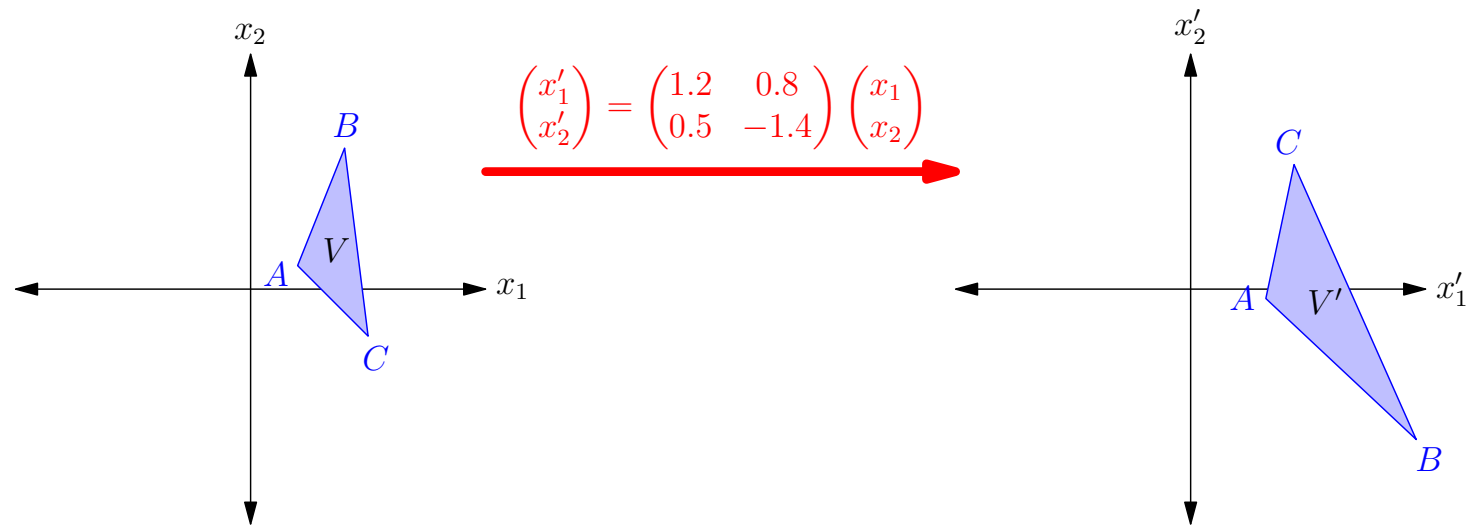
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$$\mathbf{M}(c\mathbf{a}) = c(\mathbf{M}\mathbf{a})$$

$$\mathbf{M}(\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{b}) = (\mathbf{M}\mathbf{a}) + (\mathbf{M}\mathbf{b})$$

Action Of Matrices on Volumes

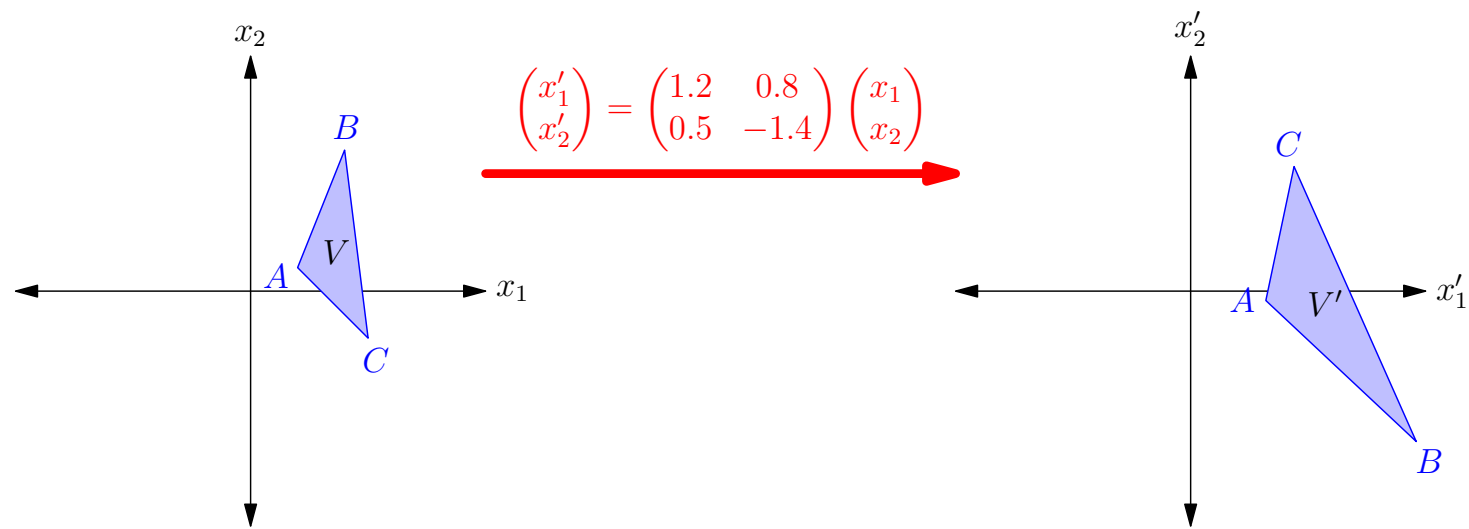
- For a closed set of points corresponding to a volume, V in $\mathbb{R}^n$, treating each point as a vector, we can ask what happens to the volume after mapping the vector by a matrix



- For square matrices, $\mathbf{M}$, the determinant is equal to $\det(\mathbf{M}) = \pm V'/V$
- The sign tells us if there has been a reflection

Action Of Matrices on Volumes

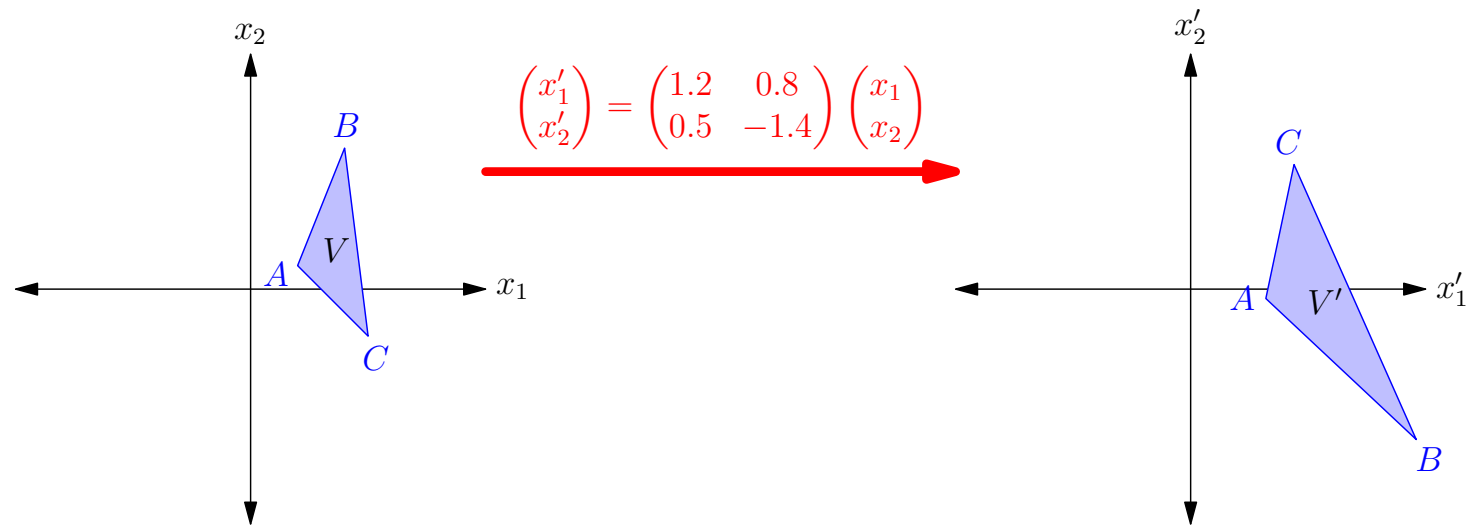
- For a closed set of points corresponding to a volume, V in $\mathbb{R}^n$, treating each point as a vector, we can ask what happens to the volume after mapping the vector by a matrix



- For square matrices, $\mathbf{M}$, the determinant is equal to $\det(\mathbf{M}) = \pm V'/V$
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Determinants

- A consequence of the fact that $\mathbf{AB}$ denotes the composition, apply mapping $\mathbf{B}$ then apply mapping $\mathbf{A}$

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Multivariate Functions

- In machine learning we heavily use multivariate functions

$$f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$$

- Often our functions will be scalar value $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$
- E.g. a learning machine for regression might be $\hat{f}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w})$
- We say a function f is linear if

$$f(c\mathbf{x}) = cf(\mathbf{x}) \qquad f(\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{y}) = f(\mathbf{x}) + f(\mathbf{y})$$

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Gradients

- The gradient of a function $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ at a point $\mathbf{x}^*$ is defined as the column vector

$$\nabla f(\mathbf{x}^*) = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial f(\mathbf{x}^*)}{\partial x_1} \\ \frac{\partial f(\mathbf{x}^*)}{\partial x_2} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial f(\mathbf{x}^*)}{\partial x_n} \end{pmatrix}$$

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- To reason about events with uncertain outcomes we introduce **random variables**
- Random variables corresponds to objects that we assign numbers to depending on the outcome of a random event
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- A continuous random variable might be the temperature at 12 noon tomorrow in Hyde park

Probability Distributions

- For discrete events, we can define a **probability mass function** $\mathbb{P}(X = x)$ that the random variable takes the value x
- This is a number between 0 and 1 with $\sum_{x \in \mathcal{X}} \mathbb{P}(X = x) = 1$
- For continuous events the probability of X taking a particular value x is zero
- Instead we consider the probability density $f_X(x)$ which we can define as

$$f_X(x) = \lim_{\delta x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\mathbb{P}(x < X \leq x + \delta x)}{\delta x}$$

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Expectations

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- We will revisit most of these topics to gain a better understanding, but you will be lost in the other machine learning modules if you are not familiar with everything I've covered
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